SpeechGeek Presents



H.I.larious, Vol. 1

SpeechGeek

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Watching our favorite funny people makes comedy look deceptively easy. Witty observations and retorts roll effortlessly off their tongues. Their comic timing is seemingly second nature.

The process of crafting a humorous performance, as many of us know, is not always so easy. We know that comedic performers have different skill sets. A person's sense of humor is highly subjective. We also know that it can be difficult to find a piece that speaks to the unique talents of forensics performers and appeals to both judges and audience members.

That's why we're excited to introduce our first collection of H.I.larious scripts. Written with humorous intent, these five brand new pieces can be performed in solo events (such as H.I.) or as Duos. Be it pop culture, slice-of-life, or even a touch of fantasy, these selections offer performers an opportunity to shine and audiences the opportunity to laugh.

Corey Alderdice
Publisher



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Nancy Brinkman...

by Matt Mills

(An alarm clock goes off. NANCY wakes up and gets ready.)

NANCY. (*to audience*) 6:00 a.m. Waking up early. Crime doesn't rest, so neither do I—at least not right now because I have to get ready for school or my mom will be mad. But that's beside the point…

(Like a superhero putting on the many small pieces of her uniform, NANCY puts on her clothes, backpack, glasses, etc.)

NANCY. Stealth jeans? Check. Protective wristband? Check. Phone that only dials City Hall? Check. Cute *Dora the Explorer* t-shirt? Super check. Time to take some criminals to school!

(Transition to school. NANCY walks through the halls, scanning all activity.)

NANCY. (*to audience*) Okay, more like fight criminals *at* school. I arrive unscathed, although slightly hungry. I may eat my lunch early today. I'm in charge around here. All knowledge of who I am slips into the shadows as I patrol the halls for danger… Nancy Brinkman. Ten years old. Mild eczema. It's all gone once I put on my uniform. Except for the eczema. With my costume, I am…an elementary school superhero!

BOY. Why are you wearing all that stupid stuff?

NANCY. Shut up! It's not stupid… I am Superhero!

BOY. Your superhero name is Superhero?

NANCY. (*beat*) Yes. Because I am the best one of those. Now leave me alone or I'll tell the principal you're eating the trash again.

BOY. Whatever.

NANCY. (*to audience*) That was a close one. You never know what kind of trouble you'll run into in these hallways.

(LITTLE BOY cries hysterically.)

NANCY. (*to audience*) Showtime.

(NANCY walks over to the little boy.)

NANCY. What's the matter, little boy? Cat got your… cat?

LITTLE BOY. I dropped my toy in the mud!

NANCY. Hmm… This reeks of foul play.

LITTLE BOY. It reeks of mud!

NANCY. But first…we must figure out who would want your toy to be covered in mud… Who had the motive?

LITTLE BOY. It was an accident! I just dropped it.

NANCY. Nonsense! You're safe now, you little idiot. Tell me who did this and I will unleash justice upon them like the kraken being unleashed from the depths of the underworld! Who did this?

LITTLE BOY. Um…gravity?

NANCY. You can be honest with me. No kid should walk around school feeling scared, and none shall. Not while I'm around!

LITTLE BOY. That's from *Sweeney Todd*...
NANCY. You're from *Sweeney Todd*! Let me help you, you moron!
LITTLE BOY. Listen to—
NANCY. SH! Do you hear that?
LITTLE BOY. Yes, it's—
NANCY. The sound of injustice reigning supreme.

(NANCY rushes over to GIRL who's looking at a graded test.)
GIRL. Oh my god! A 93! Yes! Holy fishsticks—my dad's gonna be so happy! Maybe he'll even make me some fishsticks!
NANCY. What seems to be the problem, el chica?
GIRL. Nothing at all. Quite the opposite, in fact! I just did really well on a test!
NANCY. Did really well on a test? Or did really well at smuggling drugs from Colombia?
GIRL. (*pause*) Did really well on a test.
NANCY. Sure. Sure. Sure. Just explain one thing to me...why is that sheet of paper in your hands so white? It seems to be the same color as that sinful powder you're pedaling through these rundown streets!
GIRL. All paper is w—
NANCY. Give me one good reason why I shouldn't end your educational career right now!
GIRL. Because you're entirely incapable of doing that?
NANCY. You watch your tone, missy! Don't think I won't end you like they ended *The Office*! Slow and painful.
GIRL. You're an idiot. (*walks away*)
NANCY. I don't think so! Somewhat sure I'm not! (*to audience*) Another mission accomplished. Who knows how many people I just saved from the wrath of that urban drug lord? I wish this place didn't need me, but it does.

(A jock, JAKE, bullies the little boy.)
JAKE. Give me your money, man!
LITTLE BOY. No! Leave me alone!
NANCY. A school bully? Not on my watch! (*to audience*) My watch has unicorns on it. (*NANCY runs over to them.*)
NANCY. Hey!
JAKE. I'm gonna cut you like a thing that gets cut!
LITTLE BOY. I'll call the police!
NANCY. No need for that, little sir. Superhero is here!
JAKE. Who?
NANCY. Me. I. I is that. Here I am!
JAKE. Can we help you?
NANCY. It is I that will be the helper. Man, I'm suddenly bad at my one-liners... I'm the helper here!
JAKE. The Hamburger Helper? (*laughs*)

NANCY. That was an amazing comeback, but no. Little boy, allow me to save you from this bully!
JAKE. Oh no, I'm not a bully. I'm—
NANCY. You shut your mouth before I fill it with off-brand cereal! Do you know who I am?
JAKE. Nancy Brinkman. Didn't you pee your pants when our class went to the zoo?
NANCY. A monkey peed my pants! I mean... He peed on my pants, from afar... Don't try to turn this around, you sick villain! I know you're behind all the injustice in this school! And I'm gonna make you pay!
JAKE. With what? Cash?
NANCY. With. Your...face!
JAKE. What?
(NANCY punches JAKE in the face)
JAKE. Ow! Why did you do that!
NANCY. Ooh! (*She clutches her hand in pain. To audience.*) Justice hurts so good!
LITTLE BOY. What is wrong with you?!
NANCY. I care too much?
LITTLE BOY. Jake's not a bully, he's my scene partner!
NANCY. You're in on this too, little boy?! Don't think I won't punch you, too!
(NANCY raises her fist. JAKE rushes to protect the little boy.)
JAKE. Whoa! Whoa Whoa! No! My mom wanted me experience more before I got to middle school, so I started taking drama lessons.
LITTLE BOY. He's really a natural.
JAKE. Aw, thanks man!
LITTLE BOY. Of course! You're super talented.
NANCY. Yeah, I could really tell—I mean... You're lying!
LITTLE BOY. Go away before I tell the principal you peed on that monkey.
NANCY. Hm. Nice. Well played, little boy. (*turns away, then turns back*) Did I at least save your character from a bully? Or—
LITTLE BOY. Principal!!!
NANCY. Uh-oh!

(Transition to PRINCIPAL'S office)
NANCY. I'm innocent, Principal Allen!
PRINCIPAL. Nancy, how many people are you going to punch before you learn that you can't run around pretending to be a superhero?
NANCY. Apparently more than 38.
PRINCIPAL. Nancy, this is a very serious matter.
NANCY. Nothing is more serious than crime, Allen. Except for *Sweeney Todd*.
PRINCIPAL. Nancy, I've been trying to find a way to get through to you for years now and, well, maybe it'll hurt you to know that your hurting others has affected the way your friends look at you.
NANCY. What is it that Batman said that one time? "Be a hero long enough

that you become a villain?" That's what you should do? And I became a villain pretty quickly in my reign as a superhero, so…

PRINCIPAL. You're suspended.

NANCY. What! No! You can't do that! That's not one of your superpowers!

PRINCIPAL. No, it's one of my regular powers.

NANCY. Only the League of Superheroes has that ability, and to get ap proval from the board would take weeks! There's no way you could've gotten it approved—

PRINCIPAL. Come on, Nancy! I've got things to do!

NANCY. Oh, wait… I see…

PRINCIPAL. Now what?

NANCY. You're behind all of this.

PRINCIPAL. Oh, please—

NANCY. Ah ah ah…so it was you all along! Principal Allen. Or should I say…Evil Doctor Gramimuto!

PRINCIPAL. I went to the University of Michigan! I'm an elementary school principal! I have a 48-year-old wife and two Labradoodles!

NANCY. A clever cover up for your world-conquering adventures as the greatest super villain these halls have ever seen!

PRINCIPAL. Nancy—

NANCY. You've had an impressive run, I must admit.

PRINCIPAL. Stop…

NANCY. There's just one thing I don't understand…Why did you have to put the kid's toy in the mud? It was an unnecessary and sloppy step on your part.

PRINCIPAL. Nancy, you're expelled.

NANCY. What?

PRINCIPAL. You're done here.

(NANCY freezes, awkwardly turns, and then turns back.)

NANCY. Does that mean my superhero persona is expelled, or I am?

PRINCIPAL. Both.

(Nancy turns, then turns back once more.)

NANCY. Is there any way I can bribe you out of this—

PRINCIPAL. Leave!

(transition to NANCY walking through the halls of a new school)

NANCY. (*to audience*) So, after being exiled to a school near the middle of nowhere, I picked up right where I left off. Stealth jeans? Check. Protective wristband? Check. Phone that only dials City Hall? Check. Cute t-shirt? Super duper check. Time to take criminals to school!

(She notices a little girl crying.)

LITTLE GIRL. Aw, my toy fell in the mud!

NANCY. (*to audience*) Jackpot.

Forest of Friendship

by Matt Mills

(A tree sways in the wind.)

TREE. Man, being a tree is awesome. I can totally…uh… I can… uh…(*sees a bird land on him*) Oh look, a bird! Hey, man, want to hang out? I know you do! I know you do! (*The bird poops on his face.*) Every time! Hey rock… You awake?

ROCK. Always. Stream is doing his stupid 'splsh' routine again.

STREAM. Splsh. Splsh. Splsh. Splsh. Splsh.

ROCK. Who could fall asleep to the sound of a stream?

(A man walks into the forest.)

MAN. Whoa, look! I'm in a forest!

TREE. (*whispering*) Guys! We've got company! Look alive! Actually… Don't!

(*The tree sways in the wind, performing a hypnotically pastoral dance. The rock shifts smoothly in place while the stream continues its flowing 'splsh' routine*)

MAN. Man, this forest is stupid.

TREE. Every time!

STREAM. At least they didn't throw rock at me this time.

ROCK. You loved that and you know it!

TREE. Nobody respects us, guys! People just keep coming in here and telling us we suck, that there's nothing interesting about forests, and that we should be demolished and replaced with a Dave & Buster's…

ROCK. That's not a bad idea, actually.

TREE. What are we gonna do?!

ROCK. Stay in place and let mom erode us to death. What else would we do? None of us can move!

STREAM. (*undulating*) Speak for yourself, buddy!

TREE. We've got to start impressing people when they see us! We'll never beat out the Dave & Buster's-es of the world if we don't impress people! Now how do we go about doing that?

ROCK. I've got it!

TREE. What?!

ROCK. Moss. Thanks, Obama!

STREAM. Splsh. Splsh.

TREE. Guys, focus here! Let's think about it…what impresses you?

ROCK. Wind and water over a long period of time.

STREAM. Yeah I do! I totally do that.

TREE. Focus! Let's see… When you meet someone you impress…you have to…charm them! Yeah, that's right! Let's charm them with our wit!

ROCK. What wit?

STREAM. Splsh splsh splsh.

TREE. I don't know. Just…just…just think of something!

(WOMAN walks into the forest.)

WOMAN. Oh look, honey! A forest with one tree, one rock, and a stream!

TREE. This is our chance, boys!

WOMAN. I am currently looking forward to getting to know this forest better!

(The WOMAN walks further into the forest. ROCK pumps out his chest and shows off his imaginarily awesome body. WOMAN keeps walking.)

TREE. Hey! Hey…you. What do you get when you combine a tree, a rock, and a stream?

WOMAN. I don't know. Wet splinters?

TREE. Nope! You're wrong as termites. You get 'potatoes!' No, wait. I think I messed that joke up.

(STREAM splashes in a seductively smooth dance)

WOMAN. It smells like cream of mushroom soup in here. Let's get out of here.

(WOMAN walks away)

TREE. Again! Ugh! That just happened again! Ugh!

STREAM. We were fine until rock took his moss off!

ROCK. It was starting to itch!

STREAM. As fun as it may sound, I'm getting pretty sick of people walking in here and telling us how terrible we are.

ROCK. Yeah! How would they like it if we came to where they lived and told them their mansions and TVs suck?

STREAM. Yeah!

ROCK. Yeah!

STREAM. Yeah!

ROCK. Yeah!

TREE. It's okay, guys. I've got a few ideas. And we'll have plenty of opportunities to try them out, what with all the morbidly obese people walking by ever since they opened that KFC-Taco Bell-McDonald's-Cheesecake Factory and Lard Emporium in the strip mall on the other side of us!

STREAM. What are we going to try next? I'm willing to dance for us!

ROCK. We need something bolder. Ha! Get it? I'm a rock.

TREE. Follow my lead!

(Transition to MAN #2 walking into the forest)

MAN #2. This forest reminds me of prison.

TREE. I am convincing you with logic…that…we are the best thing ever! Because…we've got…a rock!

ROCK. Sup! You know what you are? You're water. You're minerals. You're…tree parts, too, in some way. We created you, bro. How impressive is that?

MAN #2. Why is that stream taking off its clothes?

(STREAM unbuttons his shirt and takes it off.)

TREE. It's tradition?

MAN #2. This forest reminds me of the time I lost a fry in the crevice next to my car seat, which was worse than prison.

TREE. Dangit! That didn't work either. I wonder how my next idea will turn out…

(Transition to WOMAN #2 walking into the forest.)

WOMAN #2. This forest reminds me of prison.

(TREE stands intensely stoic, emitting great effort not to move or speak. ROCK remains tensely condensed and STREAM struggles to restrain his movements.)

WOMAN #2. This forest makes me want to go back to prison.

TREE. Dangit! Even stoicism didn't work! What's wrong with us?

STREAM. Monsanto?

ROCK. That can't be it.

TREE. Look… I think we've only got one option left. It's not pretty though…

ROCK. Neither are we.

STREAM. SPEAK FOR YOURSELF!

TREE. Are you ready?

ROCK. I don't have anywhere else to be. Let's try it.

TREE. Here we go!

(Transition to MAN walking into the forest)

MAN. Hm… (*pulls out iPhone*) I'm giving this forest one star on Yelp.

TREE. (*bullying*) Hey man, sup? You got a problem?

MAN. Uh…

ROCK. "Uh"?! I'd say he's got a speech problem, Tree!

TREE. Is that true, you sack of dog doodoo? Do you have a speech problem?

MAN. No.

STREAM. Well then…maybe…we should give you a speech problem!

MAN. Uh…no. I know a lot of people with speech problems as it is.

TREE. Ah… Then it sounds like we've accomplished our goal of scaring you. So that means you're impressed by us now, doesn't it?

MAN. I'm more inclined to light you on fire.

TREE. Son of an atmosphere!

ROCK. Hey, man. I could smush you so easily. You don't even know! Or I could trap your arm underneath me like in that movie with the Green Goblin!

STREAM. Do you have any idea how many dead bodies are floating inside me?

MAN. I'm sorry, what were you guys saying? I fell asleep right when I got here; it was so boring.

TREE. That's not even factual!

ROCK. Look, let's just give up! We're never gonna impress people! We're simply not impressive! Other things impress us. We're…depressed.

TREE. No, I won't give up! I can't! Mom didn't put us out here just to play; she wants results! And we're gonna give them to her, for Earth's sake!

STREAM. But HOW?

MAN. Oh, man. That big hot asteroid looks like it's coming straight for us! Let me see what it has on Yelp…

STREAM. Whoa! What are we going to do?

ROCK. Scream! *(screams)*

TREE. Guys, this is our chance! Let's show them what we've got!

ROCK. What do you mean?

TREE. Follow my lead!

MAN. This asteroid is not well reviewed…

TREE. Five stars on Yelp, here we come!

(TREE screams and swats the asteroid away.)

TREE. Catch it, Rock!

ROCK. Got it!

(ROCK bounces the asteroid off his chest.)

ROCK. Coming in hot, Stream!

(It falls into STREAM, which cools it off with a sizzle and stores it in its depths.)

STREAM. How cool is that asteroid?

MAN. Dude. Five stars. Five stars! We've got five stars, people!!!

TREE. Does that mean you're impressed?!

MAN #2. I'm so impressed I could eat you!

WOMAN #2. Me, too!

MAN #2. Back off, they're mine!

ROCK. Oh yeah!

TREE. We did it!

ROCK. All right!

TREE. Wooooo!

STREAM. Splsh! Splsh! Splsh! Splsh!

TREE. I guess the only way people are impressed is if you put forth your best in order to contribute something to the world. But what does it all mean, you know? That we're all just pawns in some sort of cosmic scheme trying to survive through forced symbiosis, acting like we're part of this happy coalition of hard work and sacrifice that—

ROCK. Dude, shut up! We've got our impressed people, now let's party!

(STREAM does a ridiculously exuberant dance.)

TREE. Yeah, you're right. What kind of music should I put on?

ROCK. How about *rock*? Eh? Eh? You get it? You get it?

MAN. Ugh. Three stars.

ROCK. No!

TREE. Rock!

STREAM. Splsh splsh splsh!

TREE. Every time.

Slumber Party Live

by Matt Mills

(TAMMY enters carrying a big bowl of popcorn.)

TAMMY. Hey, Julia, hurry up. Our show's about to start! Come on, I want to watch tan people yell at each other!

(JULIA enters lugging a big TV set.)

JULIA. Would you mind giving me a hand? This TV is so heavy that I think I'm getting another hernia.

TAMMY. Uh. Wow. Okay. Rude, Jules. Even if we weren't such good friends—

JULIA. *(interrupting)* best friends—

TAMMY. I would expect you to suck it up and carry a measly TV around when I ask you to.

JULIA. Nevermind, nevermind. I'm sorry I asked for help to save my body from serious harm. *(She sets the TV down.)*

TAMMY. Apology accepted.

JULIA. Can we just watch some TV now?

TAMMY. Um, actually…can you move the TV over a bit? You're blocking my fungus shway.

(JULIA glares at TAMMY and moves the TV over.)

JULIA. Now?

TAMMY. Wow, calm down, Jule-thief. Hand me the remote.

(JULIA hands her the remote.)

JULIA. You're welcome.

TAMMY. *(mocking)* You're welcome!

(TAMMY glares at her and repeatedly clicks the remote.)

JULIA. Why isn't it turning on?

TAMMY. It's not working! What did you do, Mayor Juliani?

JULIA. Nothing! It's probably just plugged in wrong or something.

TAMMY. Oh, yeah, like you're such an expert.

JULIA. Like you are!

TAMMY. Fix it, Jule-minator!

JULIA. Why don't we both fix it?

TAMMY. Fine!

JULIA. Fine!

(TAMMY and JULIA both begin slapping and fiddling with the TV in a hopeless effort to get it to work.)

JULIA. It's not working!

TAMMY. And it's all your fault! Ugh. I knew I shouldn't have trusted you with a slumber party. Maybe if we combine our energy and pray to the TV gods…

JULIA. TV's have gods?

(TAMMY places her hands on the TV.)

TAMMY. Dearest gods of the TV…we thank you for all you have done for us

over the years... Show business award ceremonies...the Olympics...reality shows about people who eat nothing but cheesy potatoes...

JULIA. You've got to be kidding me.

TAMMY. Put your hands on the TV, Jule-stin Timberlake! Without both of our energy, they'll never hear our calls!

JULIA. Are you serious?

TAMMY. As serious as Breaking Bad.

JULIA. I've never even watched that show!

TAMMY. It's quite good. Now hands on the TV!

(*JULIA reluctantly puts her hands on the TV*)

TAMMY. TV gods... We pray to you... Allow us to enter the world of television tonight!

(*TAMMY looks to the heavens, but nothing happens*)

JULIA. See? Now how ridicu—

TAMMY. I forgot the magic word!

JULIA. Oh, come on—

TAMMY. Please!

(*Lightning strikes and they are instantly whisked away inside the television. A title sequence rolls with music.*)

ANNOUNCER. Welcome, audience, to "The Fake Housewives of Mylanta"! Meet the idiots who populate this show!

TRISHANY. My name is Trishany, Yeah. I design three lines of pet funeral clothing and I don't find jokes funny. Unless they're about clothing. Or pets. Or funerals.

ASSESSABETH. I'm Assessabeth, and I am as beautiful as I am botoxed and...bikinis!

MIKE. Hi, I'm Mike. Uh... I'm married to Trishany. I'm an assistant logisti cal director for Target headquarters and, uh, what's this show about again?

SYLVIA. Hi.

NATIVIA. Hi!

SYLVIA. I'm Sylvia.

NATIVIA. And I'm Nativia.

SYLVIA. I don't like your tone, Nativia!

NATIVIA. I don't like your tone, Sylvia!

SYLVIA. Stop.

NATIVIA. Stop right there.

SYLVIA. Just stop it.

NATIVIA. Right there.

SYLVIA. That's where!

NATIVIA. You gotta stop it.

ANNOUNCER. Find out what happens next on "The Fake Housewives of Mylanta! Winter Break Edition."

TAMMY. Whoa, Julia! Look!

JULIA. Are you hallucinating the same thing I'm hallucinating?

TAMMY. Nope! We're on TV!

JULIA. I think it's more like we're *in* TV...

TRISHANY. Hi. You look lost. Kind of look like something you held dear to your heart just died. Need some clothes for a pet funeral?

ASSESSABETH. Or maybe you just need a pet to funeralize. Because I am...bikinis.

JULIA. Oh...uh...no thanks. I don't even know what that means. We're just trying to get back to our slumber party. Do you know the way out?

TRISHANY. I'll kill your pets for you.

ASSESSABETH. The beach is so much fun! But it can get super stressful.

JULIA. No, I—

MIKE. Does anybody want to go do some community service? Feed the homeless? Anything besides tan and fight?

TAMMY. Jule-jitsu, how are we going to get out of here?

SYLVIA. Oh, wow.

NATIVIA. Wooow.

SYLVIA. Wow wow wow.

NATIVIA. Wowza wowza wowz.

SYLVIA. Leaving already?

NATIVIA. Somebody's got a porcupine up their buttocks.

SYLVIA. Yeah. More like two.

NATIVIA. I don't like your tone, Sylvia!

SYLVIA. I don't like your name, Nativia!

JULIA. Yeah, it's just...you guys are terrible.

TAMMY. Where are all your facial expressions?

TRISHANY. (*no facial expression*) Can't you tell? This is anger.

ASSESSABETH. (*no facial expression*) Despondent.

MIKE. Lonely.

JULIA. Wait, Tammy! You still have the remote! Try changing the channel or something!

TAMMY. You're right! Let's get out of here, Jule-seph Stalin!

JULIA. That one was a stretch.

SYLVIA. Don't go!

NATIVIA. No!

TAMMY. Peace!

(*TAMMY clicks the remote, and they're whisked off into a spooky new place*)

ANNOUNCER. Welcome back to Paranormal Investigators!

PARA. INV. 1. Did you hear that?

PARA. INV. 2. No, but for the sake of the show, yes.

PARA. INV. 1. There's some strange activity going on in this abandoned insane asylum in Wichita, Kansas, just outside the Super Walmart.

PARA. INV. 2. Yeah, I agree. The activity is...very strange. Very strange, indeed.

PARA. INV. 1. Without a doubt amongst the strangest of activity we've ever seen here on "Paranormal Investigation: Extremely Strange Edition"

JULIA. Um...are you guys talking about us?

PARA. INV. 1. The spirits! Did you guys catch that? The spirits are calling to us.
TAMMY. We're not spirits. We're Tammy and Julia.
JULIA. Hello! We're right here!
PARA. INV. 2. Let's get some endoplomastic samples to see what we've got here...
TAMMY. You've got two teenage girls. One with neuroses and the other with irritable bowel syndrome.
JULIA. Tammy's the one with IBS.
TAMMY. Shut it!
PARA. INV. 1. Now we're using these obstenentation rods to take samples of the endoplomastic regions of the...uh...
PARA. INV. 2. Spirits.
PARA. INV. 1. Yeah. Here we go...
(The PI's pull out long rods and begin poking TAMMY and JULIA with them.)
TAMMY. Ow.
JULIA. Ouch!
PARA. INV. 1. Wow! We've never gotten readings like this before, folks!
PARA. INV. 2. The endoplomasm levels are off the charts!
TAMMY. Stop poking us.
JULIA. Seriously, get away! We're just trying to find our way home!
PARA. INV. 1. Ladies and gentlemen, as we always do on this show, we have found real live ghosts!
PARA. INV. 2. Such tragic, lost souls.
JULIA. Do you know how to get back to Tammy's house?
PARA. INV. 2. They must have undergone some sort of trauma at this "Tammy's house" around their death.
PARA. INV. 1. These poor, tortured souls.
JULIA. Tammy! Try a different channel before they try to suck us into a vacuum or something!
TAMMY. Next!

(TAMMY clicks the remote, and they're transported into a house.)
JULIA. Well at least we're in a house this time.
TAMMY. But it's not my house, Jule-ronimo. Why is it so empty?
CHRIS. Good evening. I'm Chris Hansen, Dateline NBC.
CHRISTINA. And I'm Christina Dansen, Fateline EBT.
CHRIS. Why don't you take a seat?
TAMMY. Uh...no thanks.
JULIA. We don't feel like sitting.
CHRISTINA. Seriously, guys. Take a seat.
TAMMY. We don't want—
CHRISTINA. TAKE A SEAT!
(TAMMY and JULIA sit down.)
CHRISTINA. Now...what brought you girls here tonight?
TAMMY. Well...I was just trying to watch tan people yell at each other, but Julia Roberts over here—

JULIA. Oh...You cannot blame this on me!
TAMMY. I just did. And Julia Roberts, but that was on accident.
JULIA. I can't believe you, Tammy. This is all your fault!
TAMMY. What! How?
JULIA. We used to be a pair—the two best friends ever! People would see us walking down the street and be like, "Wow. Look at those two. They are really close!"
TAMMY. Who says things like that?
JULIA. But now all you care about is yourself. Now people see us walking down the street and are probably like, "Wow. Look at those two. They are only marginally close!"
TAMMY. Jules... I had no idea. I had no idea you felt that way.
JULIA. Yep. And that's why we're here.
CHRIS. Are you sure it's not because you wanted to meet a fifteen- year-old boy with the username Xboxdominator1998?
JULIA. Yep, Chris Hansen. I'm pretty sure.
TAMMY. I'm so sorry, Julia Assange. I guess I can feel pretty insecure sometimes so I have a bad tendency—
CHRIS. All right officers, come on in!
JULIA. What! What's going on?
CHRISTINA. You two are under arrest for being perverts.
TAMMY. What?
JULIA. How is this possible?
(*Police officers handcuff TAMMY and JULIA.*)
CHRIS. Now enjoy your seats. In jail!
(*CHRIS and CHRISTINA laugh maniacally.*)
TAMMY. Noooooo!

(*Transition to TAMMY lying in bed. JULIA enters*)
JULIA. Hey Tam Tam, get up! It's showtime!
TAMMY. Wait. Why aren't we in jail for being predators?
JULIA. Um... Do you have something to tell me?
TAMMY. So...we're not...and we never...It was all a dream. It was all a dream!
(*TAMMY hugs JULIA.*)
TAMMY. Oh, Julia, thank you. Thank you, thank you, thank you, thank you, thank you! I am so lucky to have you as a friend! No...not just a friend...as my best friend!
JULIA. Yeah. Don't mention it. Can you do me a quick favor, though?
TAMMY. Anything! What is it?
JULIA. Go make me some popcorn and carry this gigantic TV down the stairs. I want to watch tan people yelling at each other, Tamrannosaurus-Rex, and I want to watch it now!
(*TAMMY seethes in anger.*)

The Lonely Girls Club

by Matt Mills

TRUDY. *(handing out packets)* All right, gals. Welcome to February's first meeting of The Lonely Girls' Club! My name is Trudy, and I'll be your moderator this evening. A little bit of fun non-fiction about myself: I am forty-three years old and make festive Christmas stockings out of my cats' fur! *(hands out stockings)* Here you go—Merry Catmas. Now, why don't we go around the circle and introduce ourselves, shall we? Hm, let's start to my left.

PARDGE. No.

TRUDY. All right, then. We'll start to my right

EMILY. Okay, well, hi, everybody. My name is Emily, I'm twenty-five years old and single, of course. I guess I'm just here becau—

TRUDY. Fascinating. Next?

TRISHY. I'm Trishy Nischy the Third, and I'm not lonely because I bought two cars last week and they both think I'm super great.

TRUDY. Sure thing, chicken wing! Denial's a good way to cope. I personally like to cope by pretending all of my cookware is the cast from Spider-Man. Next?

MELISSA. *(muttering inaudibly as she whimpers frenetically)* I…ah-in…a…chin…flo….pah!

TRUDY. Great. Great.

PARDGE. What are you people doing here? Don't you have any hobbies?

TRUDY. I believe I mentioned my Catmas stockings…

PARDGE. Sitting around whining about being single isn't going to make you any less single. It's like me sitting around wishing for the hole in my neck to be filled. It ain't gonna do anything.

EMILY. No, but together we can fight sadness!

MELISSA. Eh…chu…flar…pod.

PARDGE. Oh, bother.

TRISHY. If you think this is sooo stupid, why are you here, Miss Leather-face?

PARDGE. Donuts.

TRISHY. Oh, yeah. I can see that.

TRUDY. I can already tell this is going to be a great meeting! Now, our first group question of the day… What is your greatest fear? Why don't we start with you, Trisha?

TRISHY. It's Trishy—like squishy? My greatest fear is getting swarmed to death by paparazzi. That, and people from Denmark…

TRUDY. That fear is completely justified. Emily?

EMILY. Oh… I don't know… I guess…sometimes when I go to bed at night I worry that I'll wake up and I won't be able to get out of my apartment. And no one will be there to save me. And no one will even know I'm dead for weeks or months. And then my landlord will hand my apartment over to a new family that moves in. And they just ignore my dead body. And I stay there for all eternity surrounded by my pink and white Pottery Barn bedroom set!

PARDGE. That's messed up.

TRISHY. Pottery Barn?

TRUDY. Okay… Pardge? What's your greatest fear?

PARDGE. Breathalyzers.

TRUDY. Melissa?

MELISSA. Sha…ah…tee…pah…caterpillars.

TRUDY. Splendoodle. Now, how about we try to get to know each other's psyches by playing a fun little word association game? Hm? Yeah? How about that, gals? Does that sound good? Aren't we a good girl? Yes we are! Yes we are!

EMILY. Why are you talking to us like we're cats?

TRUDY. For this exercise, I'll say a word and you go around and say what it makes you think of. Let's start with "future."

PARDGE. Cheese.

TRISHY. Rehab.

EMILY. Pets.

MELISSA. Ah-ugh-ah.

TRUDY. Okay, our second word is "imminent."

EMILY. Obesity.

PARDGE. Obesity.

TRISHY. Rehab.

MELISSA. Ah-ugh-ah-oh-eh?

TRUDY. Okay girls, great job. One last word: "soulmate."

TRISHY. Rich.

EMILY. Imaginary.

PARDGE. Easily drugged.

MELISSA. Ah-ugh… Tall.

TRUDY. Fandidderyastic, girls. Now, what I want you to do—

ROB. *(flexing muscles)* Did one of you ladies say handsome?

TRISHY. *(extremely excited)* No!

ROB. Oh, I guess I just imagined that. Well, anyway, I'm here now… Who wants to eat chili off my biceps?

PARDGE. I'll take the chili.

TRUDY. Ladies, our guest speaker today is Rob Lobschaub. Feel free to ask him any question you want; he's here to help us figure out how to interact with men! Woo hoo diddly doo!

PARDGE. What if we're lesbians?

TRISHY. Oh, honey. No woman would be attracted to you.

TRUDY. Okay gals, ask away!

TRISHY. Hi, Rob!

ROB. 'Sup?

TRISHY. Okay, so… Do you ever have trouble getting ready in the morning because you're too attracted to your own reflection?

ROB. Yes. Next question.

MELISSA. Shih-bah…ooh…lumon…ah-blih-kah-rah…who-dah-buh?

ROB. Only on Saturdays.

PARDGE. Do you have any aunts that are single?

ROB. I do, but you look way too much like the guy from that *Texas Chainsaw Massacre* movie. You would have no shot with them.

TRISHY. Leatherface!

ROB. *(to EMILY)* What about you?

EMILY. Me?

ROB. Yeah. Ask my beautiful ear-holes a question.

EMILY. Um… I don't really have a question.

TRISHY. What?

TRUDY. How can you not have a question?

EMILY. I don't really care what you have to say.

ROB. Gasp!

EMILY. I don't mean to be a jerk—or anything—but you were pretty rude to Pardge, and you seem kind of narcissistic. You're nothing like anyone I would ever want to date…at all. So, truthfully, I don't really want to know what you think about us, dating, or anything in the universe. Really.

ROB. Okay, sure. I think I'm better than everyone else. Sure, I save all the facial hair I shave off because I believe it's too valuable to be washed down the sink. Sure, I've set up a bunch of fake online dating profiles with my picture just to prove that both men and women find me outrageously attractive. Sure, I've set up cameras all over my house to take photos of me at random times so that I have a never-ending variety of beautiful pictures of myself that I look at when I get home from work every day. But I am extremely proud to say that I don't even know what narcissistic means.

EMILY. *(frustrated)* Oh, wow.

TRISHY. I think we're soulmates!

EMILY. Girls, this guy is *exactly* our problem.

ROB. *(defensive)* I didn't do it! My friend Jonny will testify that I was with him that night!

EMILY. We're here because guys like him disrespect us—treat us like lesser beings that should just be constantly hunted like some pack of antelope on the African plains. We're all here because we don't respect ourselves by giving in to guys like him.

TRUDY. She's right!

EMILY. Thank you, Trudy.

TRUDY. We should go to a club and get other guys like him!

EMILY. No, that's not at all—

TRISHY. Yeah! Let's go to the club!

PARDGE. Booze? I'm in.

EMILY. No, I—

TRISHY. Let's go dancing!

TRUDY. Put on your Catmas stockings, ladies…We're going to the club!

(Transition to the club.)

TRUDY. *(dancing)* This music makes me feel like I'm thirty again!

TRISHY. Oh, come on. It's not that bad.

GUY 1. Which one of you ladies wants to go back to my place and watch me eat some cheese?

PARDGE. Yes, please.

GUY 1. Uh, no. Get away from me.

TRUDY. Don't worry, Pardge. He seemed like he didn't like cats anyway. What about this guy? *(calling out)* Hey! You guy!

GUY 2. Somebody said my name?

EMILY. Your name is Guy?

GUY 2. I used to have a name, but I forgot it when I was twelve. 'Sup?

TRISHY. I was just wondering… If I said you had a beautiful body, would you hold it against me? Because I really don't want to create a grudge the first time I meet you.

GUY 2. *The Grudge* was a good movie. So was *Parent Trap*, though I thought the blonde chick was a little mouthy.

EMILY. Do you ladies see my point yet?

GUY 2. One time, when I was twelve, I ate a whole can of paint. By myself. In one sitting.

PARDGE. I think you're my soulmate.

GUY 2. You wish. The only women I date that are your age are either cougars, divorcees, a combination of the two, or ghosts. Or a combination of all of those. But you can stalk me if you want.

EMILY. Ladies, we don't have to put up with guys like this! There are plenty of nice, sweet guys out there just dying for a chance to be with us. Just, please, listen to me… We don't need these jerks.

TRISHY. How else are we supposed to feel validated?

MELISSA. I've figured it out…

TRUDY. Melissa?

MELISSA. If we don't respect ourselves then no one else will, so it becomes this vicious cycle of disrespect that can only be broken by our own willpower! Gals, let's end the cycle tonight by not giving in to toolbags!

TRISHY. That's amazing, Melissa!

TRUDY. Why didn't you say that earlier?

EMILY. That's basically what I've been saying the whole t—

MELISSA. Let's do it, ladies!

TRUDY. Yeah!

MELISSA. Let's make up for every guy who's every treated us poorly or given us a fake address when we were supposed go meet his parents!

PARDGE. Yeah!

MELISSA. We'll make up for the times they made us watch football, even though our brother was killed in a tragic yet entirely unrelated to watching football skiing accident!

TRISHY. Ye…yeah!

MELISSA. Let's say good night to our old ways and good morning to our new ones!

EMILY. Sure.

MELISSA. Let's live for tonight and kill everyone in this club!

EMILY. Wait... What?

TRUDY. You had me up until that last part...

MELISSA. Let's go around murdering all of these people!

PARDGE. I'm one step ahead of you, pal.

TRISHY. What's murder?

EMILY. Girls, we're not killing anybody tonight. All we need to do to break the cycle is respect ourselves and not give in to just any guy that comes by.

MELISSA. Hey! That's what I said...

EMILY. You shut your mouth, Melissa!

MELISSA. *(muttering inaudibly as she cries frenetically)* Ah...chin...flo....pah!

GUY 3. Excuse me—

EMILY. Really? I'm in the middle of something. *(dismissing him)* Just go eat a taco or something

GUY 3. I'm a male feminist reporter at *The Local Tribune* and this conversation has been the most beautiful thing I've ever heard. I know what you're thinking: male feminist reporter? Is that actually your job title? And, yes, it is. I was hoping I could interview you so that the world knows how strong women are and how male-biased our culture is. It's part of my larger theme of empowering women to believe in their own strength and abilities. Would you be interested?

EMILY. Holy buckets... I'm in love!

Gary and Tina Riverdance...

by Matt Mills

(GARY walks into his cubicle and begins organizing his things. TINA enters and works on her side of the shared workspace)

GARY. Hey, Tina. How was your weekend?

TINA. It was fine. My polyps were acting up a bit, but at least no tourists threw sand at me. You?

GARY. Some teenagers tried to make me fart rainbows. Fortunately this time none of them used my horn to open a bag of Skittles.

TINA. Aw, they sound like nice kids!

GARY. They really were.

(Their boss, CHELVIN, enters.)

CHELVIN. What's up, my Mother Nature accidents?

GARY. Good morning, Chelvin.

CHELVIN. Whoa whoa whoa. You refer to me as Sir Chelvin the Third because that is a super cool sounding name, and I wish it was mine. Say, Gary, while I've got you here and not off running around on clouds made of marshmallows, have you taken care of the Spielman invoices? Or are you just waiting for those to grow out of your forehead too? *(laughs unapologetically)*

GARY. Yeah, yeah. I finished them. And you know...you don't have to refer to the fact that I'm a unicorn every time you ask me for something.

CHELVIN. Aw, man, I'm sorry! Are you worried people are going to hear me and find out you actually exist?

GARY. Alright, I guess that was kind of a good comeback.

CHELVIN. Hey, Tina. You have a weird name for a dude.

TINA. That's because I'm not a dude, I'm a woman. Even man o'wars can be women. Why does nobody realize that?

CHELVIN. I was actually just referring to the fact that women don't belong in the workplace, but—

GARY. Look, is there anything you need? Or do you just want to keep making jokes about our abnormal species? We've got a lot of work to do and—believe me—we've heard it all before. Horse princess, fairy stallion...

TINA. Roadkill of the sea...

GARY. Yeah. We've heard it all.

TINA. So could we just get back to work?

GARY. Please?

CHELVIN. Oh really? You've got a lot of work to do? What? Do you...have to fly to Candyland to save some goblins from the tooth fairy or some thing?

GARY. None of that had anything to do with unicorns. What are you, even? Huh? How about you? You're like some sort of...ugly giant worm.

CHELVIN. Actually, I am an attractive human being. A very, very attractive

one. I can bench press like 100 pounds. Plus, simply being a human means I am infinitely better than you. (*laughs*) Oh, man, I love having a cerebral cortex! Peace out, weirdoes!

(CHELVIN exits)

GARY. Believe it or not, I do not enjoy that man.

TINA. Nobody likes their boss.

GARY. It's not just him though. Aren't you sick of all of them? Every time you go to make some toast and someone says "Hey. You look like a jellyfish. Why don't you just put yourself on that toast?" I know I'm sick of getting my horn fondled every time I go through airport security.

TINA. Everyone's sick of that.

GARY. Tina, it's time we show the world what we're capable of.

TINA. Being entry-level accountants at a company that steals money from impoverished orphanages?

GARY. No. I mean our true potential...the one thing you and I both know we were accidentally put on earth to do.

TINA. You don't mean...

GARY. I do mean...

TINA. Should we count down and then both say what we're thinking at the same time?

GARY. I almost started doing that without you anyway.

TINA. One...

GARY. Two...

TINA. Three...

BOTH. Riverdancing!

(They give each other an exuberant high-five. Transition to them stretching in a dance practice room.)

GARY. So there's a huge, cool, and awesome televised riverdancing competition three weeks from now...

TINA. Televised? What channel?

GARY. Fox News.

TINA. A dream come true! Do you really think we can be ready by then?

GARY. I know we can. And just to make extra sure that we are, I hired a few professional trainers to get us ready.

TINA. Nice! What are their names?

HANS. There are no names in riverdancing!

NANS. Only rivers!

HANS. ...And dancing.

GARY. Tina, I'd like you to meet Hans and Nans. Together, they're the winningest riverdancing coaches of all time.

NANS. In ze universe!

HANS. Ja.

TINA. Wow, it's an honor to meet you. So, how do we get started?

HANS. Silence!

NANS. Have you ever heard a river speak?

TINA. Uh...no...

HANS. To riverdance...

NANS. You must be ze river.

HANS. What color is your liquid?

NANS. Unicorn, go!

GARY. Uh...it's blue?

HANS. Why are you talking?

NANS. Can rivers talk, Hans?

HANS. No they cannot, Nans.

NANS. So stop talking!

TINA. All right, this is all...weird... and everything, but we really need to learn how to riverdance, like, right now. The only way we can get people to take us seriously is to get really good at riverdancing so please... Help us!

HANS. You want to dance, miss river?

NANS. Show us how you dance.

TINA. This isn't a trap, is it?

GARY. I don't know, but I'm too scared to say no...

HANS + NANS. Now!

(GARY and TINA bust out a short dance routine—it's sloppy and bad.)

HANS. Vomit.

NANS. Vomit everywhere!

HANS. In ze kitchen...

NANS. Ze bathroom...

HANS. Ze living room...

NANS. Ze autobahn...

TINA. Yeah, we get it. A lot of vomit.

GARY. Vomit all over.

HANS + NANS. Again!

(TINA and GARY yelp fearfully then perform a more spirited short routine.)

HANS. I am dead inside.

NANS. You have hollowed out my insides with a spoon made from ze tears of a thousand dying angels.

HANS. Again!

(They dance with great energy, but are interrupted.)

NANS. Again!

(They exert all their energy into a short dance.)

HANS. Again!

(They go all out with a big, energetic dance.)

NANS. YES!

HANS. NOW YOU KNOW HOW TO RIVERDANCE!

NANS. That will be ten thousand American dollars.

TINA. Awesome!

(GARY and TINA high-five exuberantly. Transition to the riverdancing competition.)

ANN 1. Hello and welcome to the 29th annual Winchesterburford Riverdancing National Championship, presented by Vicks VapoRub. "Vicks: it feels good some of the time."

ANN 2. That it does, partner. Tastes great in your orange juice, too.

TINA. All right, Gary, you ready?

GARY. I was born ready! Not actually, though. It took a lot for me to get read—

TINA. Let's do this!

ANN 1. Our first contestants of the evening are Gary the Unicorn and Tina the Man o' War.

ANN 2. And that is not a joke, apparently. I had to ask our producer about fifteen times.

ANN 1. Let's see what they've got!

ANN 2. Hopefully some Vicks VapoRub!

ANN 1. Amen, partner.

GARY. Hi! I'm Gary. That's Tina. Hold on to your seats, ladies and gentle men, because they may just get up and dance when they see this.

TINA. Hit it!

(GARY turns on a boombox and they begin a well-polished riverdance routine.)

TINA. This is going well!

GARY. Are we supposed to talk while we dance?

TINA. I don't know, I don't really know much about riverdancing.

ANN 1. Gary and Tina seem to be talking to each other.

ANN 2. You are definitely not supposed to talk while riverdancing.

ANN 1. Or while using Vicks VapoRub.

(GARY and TINA recover with great energy and intensity.)

ANN 1. This is going surprisingly well.

ANN 2. They just might get better than last place!

ANN 1. Maybe I should get a horn. Do you think that would be a good look for me?

ANN 2. Only if I can get some tentacles!

TINA. Let's kick it into overdrive!

GARY. Consider it kicked! By my silky hind legs!

(GARY and TINA bust out huge dance moves that would never be seen in riverdancing. They dance with immense confidence and fun and finish with a ridiculous pose.)

TINA. Boom!

GARY. Explosions!

TINA. And confetti…

ANN 1. And Vicks VapoRub!

ANN 2. Well, even though only one team has competed, we have the results!

ANN 1. The 2013 Winchesterburford Riverdancing National Champions are…definitely not Gary and Tina!

TINA. Wait.

GARY. Did he just…

ANN 2. They get last place and are an embarrassment to the world.

ANN 1. Actually, I think you mean the universe.

ANN 2. Yes… Yes I did. My mistake. Sorry everyone, correction: they are an embarrassment to the entire universe.

TINA. What?

GARY. But we—

ANN 1. I apologize to our lord and savior, Vick, the father of our beloved VapoRub, for being associated with the worst travesty this sport has ever seen.

TINA. We get it, we get it!

GARY. Let's go home, Tina.

ANN 2. Up next are Amanda Bynes and the ghost of Steve Jobs.

ANN 1. Hopefully they've improved since last year.

ANN 2. I can't imagine they could've gotten worse.

(Transition to GARY organizing things at his desk. TINA enters and works at her desk.)

GARY. Morning, Tina.

TINA. Yeah.

GARY. How are your polyps doing?

TINA. Yeah.

(CHELVIN walks in with an arrogant pep in his step.)

CHELVIN. What's up, my creatures?

(GARY and TINA let out an annoyed sigh.)

CHELVIN. Hey. Gar-bear. I need those Spielman receipts on my desk by three.

GARY. Yes, sir.

CHELVIN. Awesome sauce, my horse with a schnoz.

(CHELVIN turns to leave, but then comes back.)

CHELVIN. Oh, and by the way…

TINA. What is it, Chelvin?!

GARY. I will impale you with my—

CHELVIN. Your dance was awesome!

GARY. Wait…

TINA. What?

GARY. This is a trap…

CHELVIN. No! I'm a huge Fox News fan and your routine was super dope, you freaks! I can't believe they picked Amanda Bynes and that translu cent dude over you. You guys rocked it!

GARY. Oh.

TINA. Thanks!

GARY. It's no big deal…

TINA. We didn't practice or rehearse or get coached by scary Germans or anything even.

CHELVIN. Dope. So dope. Almost too dope. Proud of you guys. See you at the hot dog luncheon!

GARY. Okay!

TINA. Yeah, sure. Bye Chelvin!
GARY. Did you hear that?
TINA. Of course! I don't even have ears and I heard it!
GARY. Riverdancers?
TINA. For life.

(GARY and TINA stand up and perform a few dance moves, ending with their aforementioned giant and ridiculous pose.)

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